

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics | University of Utah

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Research Interests: Health Economics | Labor Economics | Development Economics | Welfare Economics | Public Economics | Law & Economics | Political Economy

Professional Profile

Health, labor, and development economist studying how vulnerability, economic shocks, caregiving responsibilities, mental health systems, finance, and labor-market institutions shape productivity, welfare, and population health outcomes. Current research integrates applied microeconometrics, macro-micro analysis, vulnerability measurement, welfare valuation, cost-of-illness estimation, and policy evaluation.

Education

University of Utah — Ph.D. in Economics (ongoing). Fields: Health Economics, Labor Economics, Development Economics, Welfare Economics, Law, Economics & Policy.

Dissertation Committee: Fernando Wilson (Chair), Norm Waitzman, Sarah Small, Megan Reynolds, Francisco Perez.

University of San Francisco — M.Sc. International & Development Economics (2022), GPA 3.96/4.00, Valedictorian.

University of Agriculture Abeokuta — B.Sc. Agricultural Economics, First Class Honors (2016).

Job Market Paper

Psychiatric Service Utilization, Vulnerability, and Economic Burden under Nigeria's Pre-2023 Mental Health System. Using patient-level psychiatric records, macroeconomic indicators, and crisis shocks (GFC, Ebola, COVID-19), the paper develops a Mental Health Vulnerability Index (MHVI), estimates psychiatric service utilization pathways, and quantifies productivity losses and economic burden.

Working Papers and Research in Progress

- Measuring and Valuing Structural Caregiver Vulnerability in the United States: Development of a Caregiver Vulnerability Index (CVI), Leave-One-Out identification framework, and Marginal Compensation Rate (MCR) – 2019-2023.
- Labor Market Institutional Generosity, Economic Risk Protection, and Population Mental Health in the United States (1999-2021).
- How Worthy is Thy Skin Tone? A Socioeconomic Analysis in Nigeria (2023).
- Gendered Crises: Economic Shocks, Epidemics, and Mental Health in Nigeria (2000–2023).
- Labor Market Institutional Generosity and Birth Outcomes in the United States (with Megan Reynolds).
- Colonial Educational Legacy, Human Capital Formation, and Migration in Nigeria.
- Fueling Inflation: PMS Pump Price Pass-Through to Staple Food Prices in Nigeria.

Research Experience

Graduate Research Assistant, University of Utah (2023–Present). Research on mental health economics, labor-market institutions, caregiver vulnerability, administrative health records, BRFSS, policy evaluation, MHVI, CVI, MCR, and LMIG.

Technical Skills

Econometrics & Software: Stata, R, MATLAB, GIS, Dedoose.

Methods: Causal Inference, Difference-in-Differences, Instrumental Variables, Regression Discontinuity, Survey Methods, System GMM, ARDL, ECM, VAR, Granger Causality, Vulnerability Measurement, Welfare Valuation, Cost-of-Illness Analysis, Policy Simulation.